

UNIT-V: Dynamics of Organizational Behaviour

I. Meaning of Organizational Culture & climate

Organizational culture permeates the very essence of how an institution functions. The shared values, core beliefs, established norms, and typical practices form the invisible glue binding together those within the organization. These cultural elements collectively sculpt how internal and external relationships are navigated. Deeply ingrained in the culture lies the organization's reason for being—its mission and vision—as well as the habitual rituals and meaningful symbols representing it. Subtle yet potent underlying assumptions steer behavior, for better or worse. By shaping decision-making exchanges, communications flows, and the overall mood under which work gets done, organizational culture holds tremendous sway over both the short-term and long-term prosperity of an enterprise. Conversely, cultural dysfunction can introduce formidable challenges and potentially threaten viability.

Organizational climate encompasses how employees subjectively perceive and interpret essential aspects of their work environment. It reflects the collective assessments and emotions of workers regarding various dimensions of their organization, including leadership style, information sharing, cooperation among teams, and encouragement provided. More transient than culture, organizational climate impacts daily job duties, contentment, and general sentiment among the workforce. It can fluctuate periodically and is molded by management strategies, guidelines established by administration, and the evolving activities that define operations. The executive team cultivates the climate through both declaration and demonstration of what is prioritized and rewarded concerning conduct and accomplishments.

Importance of Organizational Climate and Culture

The impact of an organization's climate and culture runs deep, profoundly shaping how workers act, find purpose, and contributing to broader success. A feel of belonging, shared aims, and boosted output arise when climate is good and culture is sturdy. Comprehending and cultivating these aspects is pivotal for crafting a place where determination and perseverance take root. Where employees receive purpose, challenges bring out the best, and each role plays a part in goals greater than any one. Togetherness, not singularly, lifts the whole to heights unattainable alone.

Importance of Organizational Climate

Organizational climate plays a critical role in shaping employee attitudes, behaviors, and overall employee satisfaction. A positive climate can lead to increased productivity, engagement, and organizational success, while a negative climate breeds dissatisfaction, inefficiency, and dysfunction.

Employee Motivation and Satisfaction

When individuals feel respected, heard, and supported within their work environment, their motivation and satisfaction increases dramatically. They are more engaged, collaborative, and committed to achieving both their own and organizational goals. In contrast, a toxic climate crushes morale and saps energy.

Productivity and Efficiency

An atmosphere promoting open communication, teamwork, and mutual respect maximizes efficiency by reducing avoidable errors and rework. Employees freely share knowledge and perspectives to continuously improve processes. However, political infighting and siloed work severely hampers productivity.

Employee Retention and Loyalty

Individuals proudly dedicating decades to an organization they feel cares for their well-being and development exemplifies the impact of climate on retention. In stark contrast, high turnover results when worker needs are neglected and they feel replaceable cogs in a machine.

Innovation and Creativity

A climate empowering risk-taking and new ideas catalyzes innovation as employees challenge conventions seeking better solutions. Yet micromanagement and reluctance to new approaches stifles creative thought.

Organizational Reputation

Satisfied, engaged employees become ambassadors building strong external relationships which elevate an organization's reputation. Meanwhile, high dysfunction and turnover brands an organization as a difficult place to work, damaging its reputation in the eyes of consumers and potential hires.

Importance of Organizational Culture

Organizational culture fundamentally shapes an organization's identity, values, and behaviors. A powerful culture aligns employees to the mission and enhances effectiveness and success when universally embraced.

Alignment Through Common Objectives

A clearly defined culture ensures employees work harmoniously toward shared aims. Internalizing core principles prompts performance driving goals.

Motivating Engagement and Fulfillment

Culture profoundly impacts how engaged and satisfied staff feel in roles by cultivating meaning and purpose. An appreciative, inclusive, cooperative environment motivates feeling valued, boosting dedication and job satisfaction.

Adapting through Changes Resiliently

A robust culture strengthens adaptability when surroundings fluctuate. Innovation and flexibility allow navigating difficulties effectively while proactively responding to market variations.

Attracting and Retaining Top Talent

A positive culture attracts and retains elite talent by generating an appealing environment. Potential hires favor roles where culture maintains strength and inspiration, while current staff prefer remaining, reducing turnover.

Reputation and Brand Personal

Culture impacts external perception, affecting reputation and identity. Social responsibility, ethics, and employee wellness enhance standing and trust with clients and stakeholders.

Factors Affecting Organisational Culture

1) Characteristics of People within the Organisation

The ultimate source of organisational culture is the people who make up the organisation. People may be attracted to an organisation whose values match theirs; similarly, an organization selects people who share its values. Over time, individuals who do not fit in left. The result is that people inside the organisation become more and more similar, the values of the organisation become more and more pronounced and clear-cut, and the culture becomes more and more distinct from that of similar organisations.

2) Nature of Employment Relationship

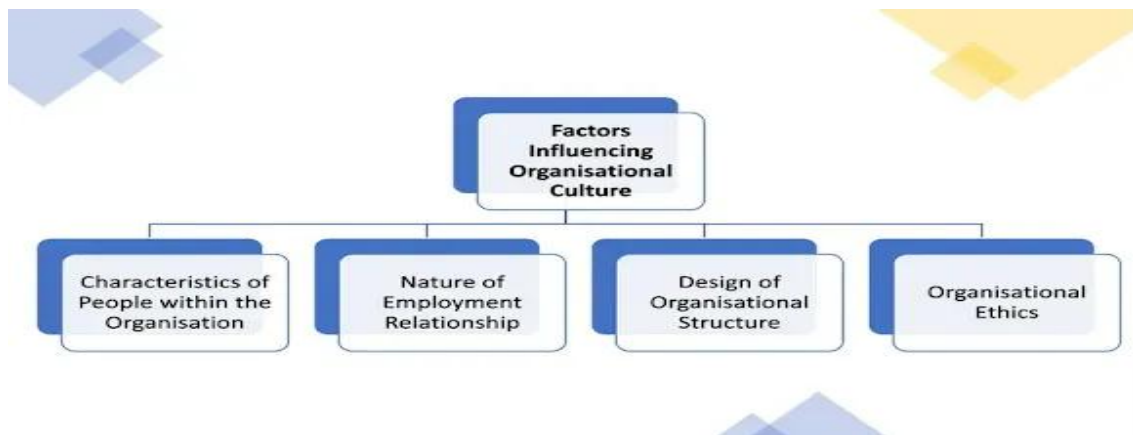
It is one of the major factors affecting organisational culture. It is the nature of the employment relationship a company establishes with its employees via its human resource policies and practices. A company's hiring, promotion, and lay-off policies along with pay and benefits, can influence how hard employees will work to achieve the organisation's goals, how attached they will be to it, and whether or not they will buy into its norms and values.

3) Design of Organisational Structure

This source of cultural values comes from the organisation's structure. An organisational structure is the formal system of task and reporting relationships that an organization establishes to coordinate and motivate its employees. Because different structures give rise to different cultures, managers need to design a certain kind of organisational structure to create a certain kind of culture.

4) Organisational Ethics

An organisation can purposefully develop some kinds of cultural values to control the way its members behave. One important class of values that falls into this category stems from organisational ethics, the moral values, beliefs, and rules that establish the appropriate way for an organisation and its members to deal with each other and people outside the organisation: Ethical values rest on principles stressing the importance of treating everyone fairly and equally.



Factors affecting organizational climate

The factors affecting organizational climate are diverse and can vary significantly between organizations. Here are some key factors that influence the climate within an organization:

Organizational Context: The mission, vision, goals, and functions of the organization play a crucial role in shaping the climate.

Structure: The framework that establishes formal relationships and delineates authority and functional responsibility. Decentralized structures are generally believed to result in a sound climate.

Process: Processes such as communication, decision-making, motivation, and leadership are vital for achieving organizational goals.

Physical Environment: The external conditions of the workplace, including size, location, and overall environment, can also impact the climate.

II. Introduction: Job satisfaction

Job satisfaction is the feeling and perception of a worker regarding his/her work and how he or she feels well in an organization. It indicates the extent of employees' positive or negative feelings towards their jobs and organizational behaviour tried to improve it. In Organizational Behavior, job satisfaction is one of the most researched variables in workplace psychology and has been associated with numerous psychosocial issues, the changing world of work, organizational factors ranging from leadership to job design. It is the level of contentment a person feels regarding his or her job. This feeling is mainly based on an individual's perception of satisfaction. It can be influenced by a person's ability to complete the required tasks, the level of communication in an organization, and the way management treats employees. There are different levels of job satisfaction.

Meaning of Job Satisfaction: Job satisfaction refers to a person's feeling of satisfaction on the job, which acts as a motivation to work. It is not the self-satisfaction, happiness or self-contentment but the satisfaction on the job. Satisfaction does mean the simple feeling-state accompanying the attainment of any goal; the end state is feeling accompanying the attainment by an impulse of its objective. Job dissatisfaction does mean absence of motivation at work.

Definition of Job Satisfaction: • "The pleasurable emotional state resulting from the appraisal of one's job as achieving or facilitating the achievement of one's job values"- E. A. Locke • "Job satisfaction is the extent to which people like or dislike their jobs". - P. E. Spector Job Satisfaction

Factors: Job satisfaction is related to the psychology of an employee. A happy & content employee at a job is always motivated to contribute more. On the other hand, a dissatisfied employee is lethargic, makes mistakes & becomes a burden to the company.

The elements & factors which contribute to job satisfaction are:

1. Compensation & Working conditions One of the biggest factors of job satisfaction are the compensation and benefits given to an employee. An employee with a good salary, incentives, bonuses, healthcare options etc. is happier with their job as compared to someone who doesn't have the same. A healthy workplace environment also adds value to an employee.
2. Work life balance Every individual wants to have a good workplace which allows them time to spend with their family & friends. 16 Job satisfaction for employees is often due a good work life balance policy, which ensures that an employee spends quality time with their family along with doing their work. This improves the employee's quality of work life.
3. Respect & Recognition Any individual appreciates and feels motivated if they are respected at their workplace. Also, if they are awarded for their hard work, it further motivates employees. Hence recognition is one of the job satisfaction factors.
4. Job security If an employee is assured that the company would retain them even if the market is turbulent, it gives them immense confidence. Job security is one of the main reasons for job satisfaction for employees.
5. Challenges Monotonous work activities can lead to dissatisfied employees. Hence, things like job rotation, job enrichment etc. can help in job satisfaction of employees as well.
6. Career Growth Employees always keep their career growth part as a high priority in their life. Hence, if a company helps groom employees and gives them newer job roles, it enhances the job satisfaction as they know they would get a boost in their career.

Outcomes of job satisfaction in the workplace: 17 Management practitioners have analysed the outcomes of job satisfaction by studying the relationships between job satisfaction and various other factors.

These relationships are: **I.Satisfaction and productivity:** Researchers have shown that job satisfaction does not necessarily lead to productivity. However, while it may not bring about considerable improvement in individual performance, it does have an overall positive impact on the performance of organization.

II.Satisfaction and turnover: High job satisfaction only helps in reducing employee turnover, it does not eliminate it. Employees who are dissatisfied with their jobs immediately leave the organization when they get a better opportunity. However, employees who have job satisfaction might consider various aspects before taking a decision to quit the organization. Apart from job satisfaction, job tenure, individual commitment to organization, and the economic scenario in the country also influence employee turnover in an organization

III.Satisfaction and absenteeism: Studies have revealed that job satisfaction and absenteeism share an inversely proportionate relationship. Thus, employees who are highly satisfied with their jobs might show low absenteeism. Similarly, those who are not satisfied with their jobs might show high absenteeism. However, other factors such as the importance people assign to their jobs, etc also determine the level of absenteeism.

IV. Other effects of job satisfaction: Employees who are satisfied with their jobs have low stress levels, fewer on-the-job accidents, fewer grievances, etc. It has also been observed that highly satisfied employees are enthusiastic about learning job-related tasks, have high employee morale, help co-workers and customers, etc.

III. Organizational change and Importance

PROCESS OF CHANGE : Change is a process of moving from the current state to the desired state (vision) of the future. Making a change involves moving the organization's people and culture in line with the strategies, structure, processes and systems to achieve the desired state (vision).

Existing Situation Change (Transition) Vision Situation Desired The existing situation is the status, which is prevailing at the moment, what the organization looks like now. The desired situation is the status which one desires to prevail; it is also called vision.

A vision helps in clarifying— What do we want to become? How much needs to change? What the Organization should look like when the change is completed? The transition state may be defined by ascertaining the activities and processes necessary to transform the organization from its current state to the desired state — a road map — for specifying the activities, crucial interventions and events during the transition period.

For making an organization move from the existing state to the desired state some 'force' is to be applied. Some forces applied by the individual(s) undergoing the change oppose the force applied for moving to the desired state — this is called resistance.

This also supports Newton's third law of motion- "Every action / force creates an opposition (resistance). Successful change—the three-stage model According to Lewin's three step model, successful change in organizations should follow three steps: Unfreezing Newton's first law of motion states "Every object remains in state of rest or uniform motion in a straight line unless and until an external force is applied to it." In the organizations also similar situations exist.

When a product, service or profit is at a deteriorating stage but with the rapid changes there maintaining a 'steady state' is not possible as the situations are bringing many types of forces, usually inhibiting forces which block the pace.

For example, for a stagnant product, every product will remain stagnant and non-competitive leading to decay vertically down unless and until an external, innovative and relevant technology is proposed to cause its growth vertically upwards. Thus for making any change something has to be done in a planned way to disturb the status quo: this is called de freezing (unfreezing).

This stage aims at disturbing the existing equilibrium and creates motivation to change using mechanisms like — (a) lack of confirmation or disconfirmation (b) sharing one's concerns and perceptions openly, looking into feelings, removal of barriers of communications, induction of guilt and anxiety and creations of threats by reduction of psychological safety, presentation of alternative scenarios etc. In case of any change, the effort is going to face individual resistance and group conformity. These change efforts for overcoming the pressures of both individual resistance and group conformity.

Two types of forces emerge and at the status quo, both are in balance

a) Forces prompting the change — forces that direct the behaviour away from the status quo — "Driving forces"

b) Forces hindering the movement away from the status quo — Restraining forces. For affecting the change : The Driving forces should be identified, assessed and intensified / added. The Restraining forces should be identified, assessed and weakened / removed. Both strategies are followed simultaneous . The technique described is called 'Force field analysis'.

The method includes the following steps:

- 1) Identify the problem, which you want to work and describe it.
- 2) Define the problem clearly indicating the present situation.
- 3) Define the situation desired after the problem is solved.
- 4) Identify the forces working for the change i.e. driving force by way of individual listing, brainstorming or any other means.
- 5) Identify and list forces likely to work against the desired change (restraining forces). These forces can be related to human resource, time, money, technology, customer requirements or any other internal, external factors.
- 6) From the list of driving forces and restraining forces, prioritise the forces and identify 3-4 most significant forces under each of the both categories.
- 7) Make a force field diagram showing both types of forces after prioritization. The arrows should be proportional to their priority / strength.
- 8) Discuss and list possible action steps for reducing or eliminating the effect of the restraining forces and add or increase the effect of the driving forces.
- 9) Determine the most effective steps under both the categories of forces and outside which once to implement.
- 10) Examine the resources available for carrying out each action steps.
- 11) Develop a comprehensive action plan, sequence of activities and assign responsibilities for implementation
- . 12)Implement the plan.
- 13) Evaluate. ii) Moving / Intervening The steps to be taken for making the desired change should be planned considering all aspects — Tasks, Technology, Structure and Human Resource. Since any organization is composed of these four inter-related and interdependent components, the impact of the changes should be anticipated and examined.

Since the organizational environment is a resultant of three or four components — and any organization exist in environment analysis of internal and external environment is essential. This step aims at developing new responses by providing new information. Cognitive redefinition is a mechanism, which is achieved by identification (information) through a single source and scanning (information through multiple sources). Refreezing The change interventions start making the desired status in due course. These are to be stabilised. Refreezing stabilises a change intervention by balancing the forces which have created the desired (driving forces) and those, which are inhibiting the changes to occur (restraining forces). Here also, Newton's Second Law is quite helpful in understanding — "The rate of change of momentum is proportional to force applied and change takes place in the direction in which the force acts". Hence, for rapid and deep change, forces

applied should be strong, direction should be clear and force applied in the right direction. This stage helps stabilising and integrating the changes. This is gained by integrating new responses into persons and into significant ongoing relationships through reconfirmation.

Stability Vs Change

The balance between stability and change is crucial for organizational success. While change is necessary for growth and adaptability, stability provides the foundation for consistent performance and employee satisfaction. Here are some key points to consider:

- **Stability:** Ensures a predictable environment, which is essential for employee security and skill development. It helps in maintaining a strong organizational culture and fosters teamwork and innovation.
- **Change:** Stimulates innovation and allows organizations to respond quickly to external pressures and market dynamics. It is vital for driving competitiveness and seizing new opportunities.
- **Balance:** Achieving a balance between stability and change involves careful planning, clear communication, and active engagement from all stakeholders. It is essential to maintain core processes and routines while allowing for strategic transformation.

By understanding and managing the relationship between stability and change, organizations can navigate the complexities of their environment and achieve sustained success.

Reactive change management is a process for handling changes that arise in response to unknown problems or unplanned events or unexpected situation. It involves knowing the problem or unplanned event or unexpected situation, assessing its impact on organization and making a strategy and plan to address the problem or situation. The goal of reactive change management is to minimize the negative impact of unplanned changes and to adopt to new situation smoothly.

Examples of reactive change management

1. An organization may experience a big crash in its software systems because of a bug. The IT team must quickly identify the cause of the problem and make a big replacement in software and make the organization to adopt advance software. It is an example of reactive change management because change was made in response to an unplanned and unknown situation.
2. A company experiences a sudden surge in demand for its products that put pressure on its manufacturing and distribution capacity. The company must rapidly increase production and logistics system and improve its process in order to meet the increased demand. This would also be an example of reactive change management, as the company is making changes in response to an unplanned event.

What is proactive change management?

Proactive change management is a process for anticipating and planning for potential changes that may affect an organization in the future. It involves identifying potential changes that could impact the organization, evaluating the potential outcomes of those changes, and developing plans to mitigate any negative effects or take advantage of any opportunities presented by the changes. The

goal of proactive change management is to be prepared for future changes and to be able to adapt to them in a controlled and strategic manner.

Examples of proactive change management

1. A company identifies potential challenges by conducting a risk assessment. That risk could negatively affect the business in the future. Based on the recommendation of assessment, that company develops contingency plans to address potential disruptions such as supply chain interruptions, natural disasters, or cyber attacks. This is an example of proactive change management, as the company is anticipating and planning for potential changes in advance.
2. A company monitors market trends and customer feedback to identify potential opportunities for growth or new product development. The company then develops a strategic plan to take advantage of these opportunities and implement necessary changes to its operations or business model. This is also an example of proactive change management, as the company is proactively identifying and planning for potential changes that could impact its business.

Proactive Vs Reactive Change Management – Differences

Following are some points that highlight the difference between proactive and reactive change management:

1. Timing

The key difference between reactive and proactive change management is the timing of the change process. Reactive change management is used in response to an unplanned event or problem, while proactive change management involves anticipating and planning for potential changes of the future in advance.

2. Focus

Reactive change management tends to be more focused on addressing immediate issues and restoring normal operations, while proactive change management is more focused on preparing for the future and positioning the organization for long-term success.

3. Control

Reactive change management often involves reacting to circumstances that are beyond the organization's control, while proactive change management involves proactively identifying and addressing potential changes in order to maintain control over the change process.

4. Flexibility

Reactive change management may be less flexible, as it is often focused on addressing immediate problems and may not leave much room for long-term planning or strategic decision-making. Proactive change management, on the other hand, is more flexible and allows organizations to anticipate and prepare for a wider range of potential changes.

5. Cost

Reactive change management may be more costly, as it often involves addressing problems or unplanned events that have already occurred, which can require significant resources to fix. Proactive change management can be more cost-effective, as it involves anticipating and planning for potential changes in advance, which can help organizations avoid costly disruptions or emergencies.

6. Effectiveness

Reactive change management may be less effective in the long run, as it does not allow for the same level of strategic planning and preparation as proactive change management. Proactive change management, on the other hand, can be more effective in helping organizations adapt to changes and achieve their long-term goals.

7. Stress

Reactive change management can be more stressful, as it often involves reacting to unexpected problems or events that require immediate attention. Proactive change management can be less stressful, as it allows organizations to anticipate and plan for potential changes in advance, which can help to mitigate uncertainty and minimize the impact of changes on the organization.

8. Business continuity

Reactive change management may be less effective at maintaining business continuity, as it is focused on addressing immediate problems and may not take into account the long-term impacts on the organization. Proactive change management, on the other hand, is more focused on maintaining business continuity and ensuring that the organization is prepared for a range of potential changes that could impact its operations.

9. Collaboration

Reactive change management may be more challenging in terms of collaboration, as it often involves addressing urgent problems or events that require immediate action. This can make it difficult for stakeholders to come together and work towards a common goal. Proactive change management, on the other hand, allows for more collaboration and input from stakeholders, as it involves anticipating and planning for potential changes in advance.

10. Adaptability

Reactive change management may be less effective at helping organizations adapt to changes, as it is focused on addressing immediate problems and may not allow for the same level of strategic planning as proactive change management. Proactive change management, on the other hand, can be more effective at helping organizations adapt to changes, as it involves identifying and preparing for potential changes in advance. This can help organizations to be more flexible and responsive in the face of change.

Steps in reactive change management process

Following are the key steps in reactive change management process:

Identifying the cause of the problem or unplanned event

The first step in the reactive change management process is to identify the cause of the problem or unplanned event that triggered the need for change. This may involve gathering information about the event or problem, analyzing data or logs, or conducting interviews with relevant individuals. The goal is to understand the root cause of the issue in order to determine the most effective way to address it.

Evaluating the impact of the change on the organization

Once the cause of the problem or unplanned event has been identified, the next step is to evaluate the impact of the change on the organization. This may involve assessing the potential consequences of the change on various areas of the business, such as operations, finance, or customer relations. The goal is to understand the full scope of the impact of the change and to identify any potential risks or challenges that need to be addressed.

Developing and implementing a plan to address the problem or event

After the impact of the change has been evaluated, the next step is to develop and implement a plan to address the problem or event. This may involve identifying specific actions that need to be taken, allocating resources to support the change, and establishing a timeline for implementing the plan.

Communicating the change to relevant stakeholders

It is important to communicate the change to relevant stakeholders, such as employees, customers, or partners, in order to keep them informed and to ensure that they understand the impact of the change on their roles or responsibilities. This may involve using various communication channels, such as email, meetings, or announcements, to ensure that all stakeholders are aware of the change and its implications.

Monitoring the effectiveness of the change and making any necessary adjustments

The final step in the reactive change management process is to monitor the effectiveness of the change and make any necessary adjustments as needed. This may involve collecting data or feedback from stakeholders, evaluating the performance of the change, and making changes to the plan as needed in order to optimize results. The goal is to ensure that the change is effective in addressing the problem or event and that it does not have any negative unintended consequences.

Steps in proactive change management

Following are steps involved in proactive change management:

Identifying potential changes

The first step in proactive change management is to identify potential changes that could impact the organization. This may involve conducting a risk assessment, monitoring market trends, or gathering feedback from stakeholders. The goal is to identify potential changes that could affect the organization in the future, whether positive or negative.

Evaluating the potential consequences of the changes

Once potential changes have been identified, the next step is to evaluate the potential consequences of those changes on the organization. This may involve assessing the impact of the changes on various areas of the business, such as operations, finance, or customer relations. The goal is to understand the full scope of the impact of the changes and to identify any potential risks or challenges that need to be addressed.

Developing a plan to address the changes

After the potential consequences of the changes have been evaluated, the next step is to develop a plan to address the changes. This may involve identifying specific actions that need to be taken, allocating resources to support the change such as development of special toolkits for implementing change and establishing a timeline for implementing the plan.

Implementing the plan

Once the plan has been developed, the next step is to implement the changes in a controlled and strategic manner. This may involve executing specific actions, communicating the changes to relevant stakeholders, and monitoring the progress of the change to ensure that it is on track.

Monitoring and adjusting the plan as needed

The final step in the proactive change management process is to monitor the progress of the change and make any necessary adjustments as needed. This may involve collecting data or feedback from stakeholders, evaluating the performance of the change, and making changes to the plan as needed in order to optimize results. The goal is to ensure that the change is effective in achieving the desired outcomes and that it does not have any negative unintended consequences.

Stress

Definition

Stress is a psychological and physiological response of the body to any demand or challenge (called a stressor) that disrupts normal functioning.

Nature of Stress

- It is **universal** (everyone experiences it).
- It can be **positive or negative**.
- It involves interaction between the **individual and environment**.

Types of Stress

1. Based on Duration

- **Acute Stress:**
Short-term; arises from immediate demands (e.g., deadlines, exams).
- **Chronic Stress:**
Long-term; persists over time (e.g., financial problems, job dissatisfaction).

2. Based on Impact

- **Eustress (Positive Stress):**
Motivates individuals, improves performance (e.g., promotion opportunity).
- **Distress (Negative Stress):**
Causes anxiety, reduces performance.

Causes of Stress

- Personal problems (health, family)
- Work-related pressures
- Financial difficulties
- Environmental factors

Symptoms of Stress

Physical:

- Headache, fatigue, insomnia
- High blood pressure
- Muscle tension

Emotional:

- Anxiety, depression
- Mood swings
- Irritability

Cognitive:

- Poor concentration
- Memory problems
- Negative thinking

Behavioral:

- Substance abuse
- Social withdrawal
- Changes in eating/sleeping habits

Effects of Stress

- Reduced productivity
- Health problems (heart disease, hypertension)
- Poor relationships
- Burnout

2. Work Stressors

Definition

Work stressors are conditions or factors in the workplace that create stress among employees.

Types of Work Stressors

1. Task-Related Stressors

- Excessive workload
- Tight deadlines
- Repetitive tasks
- Lack of resources

2. Role-Related Stressors

- **Role Ambiguity:** Unclear job responsibilities
- **Role Conflict:** Conflicting expectations from different people
- **Role Overload:** Too many responsibilities

3. Organizational Stressors

- Poor management practices
- Lack of participation in decision-making
- Job insecurity
- Organizational changes

4. Interpersonal Stressors

- Conflicts with colleagues

- Lack of support from supervisors
- Workplace harassment or bullying

5. Physical Environment Stressors

- Noise, heat, overcrowding
- Unsafe working conditions

6. Career Development Stressors

- Lack of promotion opportunities
- Skill mismatch
- Stagnation

3. Prevention of Stress

Meaning

Stress prevention involves identifying and reducing stressors before they affect individuals.

A. Individual-Level Prevention

- **Time Management:** Planning and prioritizing tasks
- **Healthy Lifestyle:** Balanced diet, exercise, sleep
- **Relaxation Techniques:** Meditation, yoga, breathing exercises
- **Skill Development:** Improving competence reduces anxiety
- **Positive Attitude:** Optimistic thinking
- **Avoiding Procrastination**

B. Organizational-Level Prevention

- **Job Design:** Clear roles and responsibilities
- **Workload Management:** Fair distribution of tasks
- **Employee Participation:** In decision-making
- **Training Programs:** Stress management workshops
- **Support Systems:** Counseling services
- **Safe Work Environment**
- **Recognition & Rewards**

Primary, Secondary, Tertiary Prevention

- **Primary:** Remove stressors (e.g., reduce workload)
- **Secondary:** Help individuals cope (e.g., training)
- **Tertiary:** Treat stress-related problems (e.g., therapy)

4. Management of Stress

Meaning

Stress management involves techniques and strategies to control stress and improve well-being.

A. Individual Stress Management Techniques

1. Physical Techniques

- Regular exercise
- Yoga and stretching
- Proper sleep

2. Psychological Techniques

- Positive thinking
- Cognitive restructuring (changing negative thoughts)
- Mindfulness

3. Relaxation Techniques

- Deep breathing
- Meditation
- Progressive muscle relaxation

4. Social Techniques

- Sharing problems with friends/family
- Building support networks

5. Time Management

- Setting realistic goals
- Avoiding overload

B. Organizational Stress Management

- Flexible work hours
- Employee assistance programs (EAPs)
- Team-building activities
- Open communication
- Leadership support

Coping Strategies

1. Problem-Focused Coping

- Directly addressing the cause of stress
- Example: improving skills, better planning

2. Emotion-Focused Coping

- Managing emotional responses
- Example: relaxation, counseling

Work–Life Balance

Definition

Work–life balance is the ability to maintain a healthy equilibrium between work responsibilities and personal life.

Importance

- Reduces stress and burnout
- Improves mental and physical health
- Enhances productivity and job satisfaction
- Strengthens personal relationships

Causes of Poor Work–Life Balance

- Long working hours
- Work pressure
- Technology (constant connectivity)
- Lack of boundaries

Strategies to Achieve Work–Life Balance

1. Personal Strategies

- Set clear boundaries between work and home
- Prioritize tasks
- Practice self-care
- Spend time on hobbies
- Take regular breaks

2. Workplace Strategies

- Flexible working hours
- Remote work options
- Leave policies
- Supportive management

3. Time Management Techniques

- To-do lists
- Delegation of work
- Avoid multitasking

Organisational development

- Organisational development is a set of behavioral science based theories, values, strategies, and technique aimed at the planned change of the organisational work setting for the purpose of enhancing individual development and improving organisational performance,

through the alteration of organisational members on the job behaviours. – Porras and Roberston, 1992

- Organisational development is planned process of change in an organisation's culture through the utilization of behavioural science technologies, research, and theory. -Burke, 1994.

Objectives of Organisational development

- To increase openness of communication among people.
- To increase commitment, self-direction and self-control.
- To encourage the people who are at the helm of affairs or close to the point of actual action to make the decisions regarding their issues through collaborative effort.
- To involve the members in the process of analysis and implementation.
- To encourage confrontation regarding organisational problems with a view to arriving at effective decisions. To enhance personal enthusiasm and satisfaction levels.
- To increase the level of trust and support among employees.
- To develop strategic solutions to problems with higher frequency.
- To increase the level of individual and group responsibility in planning and execution.

following characteristic features:

Attention on the Entire Organisation:

Organisational development gives attention to the entire organisation to enable the environment in the organisation to reinforce the employees to learn whatever the programme specifies it. This learning is different from the traditional training programme that emphasises a small group or a particular job.

System Oriented:

Development of organisation is based on system approaches. The various parts of an organisation interact in such a way to give momentum for interpersonal and intergroup cooperation. The system mainly aims at proper coordination of all parts of the organisation for a better performance.

Action Research:

This process in organisational development is to do research study of various work situations. This method of study is conducted on actual work situations to understand the problematic areas and remedying it accordingly, to improve the performance of an organisation.

Problem Solving:

Action research provides the data on problems faced while executing the jobs and solving them through the practical experience gained over the years. This develops an attitude of solving the problems which ultimately leads to self- sufficiency.

Group Process:

More importance is given to group activities rather than individuals. Thus, it focuses on the improvement of group performance. Organisations have developed various ways to improve the interpersonal relations, discussion between the groups, intergroup functional conflicts, formation of team, etc., so as to help develop the capabilities of an individual to have long-lasting personal relations and intergroup communication.

Feedback:

This is the process by which one understands other's views on a certain subject. The feedback by an individual helps to provide information, on the basis of which a decision can be taken. This, in a way, contributes to organisational development. For example, the participants are divided into separate groups.

A certain group takes a decision on a given subject, which is passed on to other groups to obtain different opinions. Lastly, the members of different groups come together for a live discussion; as a sequel to which a consensus and final decision are arrived at on the given subject. Needless to mention that the total process is entirely based on the feedback, received earlier

Learning through Experience:

Organisational behaviour enables an individual to learn through experience. One can adopt new behavioural pattern through experience. It is a self-motivated process, as it is said, "Experience without learning is more than learning without experience."

Contingency Oriented:

Organisational development is basically determined on situation. People develop their behavioural concept according to their experience. They are, therefore, able to suggest various solutions to a problem and select a suitable one according to contingencies. Organisational research has the viability to select the correct solution to a problem, since it is flexible to solutions and contingencies, compared to any traditional approach for solving the problem.

Use of Change Agent:

The organisational development is that, it utilises a change agent (Catalyst) to guide the change. The change agents are normally process agents or consultants to guide the groups to an effective group process. These process agents cannot be termed as the experts to tell the group what to do.

Organizational effectiveness (OE) refers to how well an organization accomplishes its objectives using the resources it has, combining strategy, people, systems, and culture to create a resilient, high-performing entity. It is not just about efficiency—doing things right—but also about effectiveness, which means doing the right things to achieve meaningful outcomes. Effective organizations are capable of adapting to change, sustaining performance, and delivering value to employees, customers, and other stakeholders.

Key Components

1. **Goal Achievement:** The organization meets its stated objectives, whether in productivity, service quality, financial performance, or societal impact.

2. **Resource Alignment:** Internal processes, human capital, and material resources are optimized to support strategic goals.
3. **Adaptability and Innovation:** Effective organizations respond flexibly to market changes, technological advances, and evolving customer needs.
4. **Leadership and Culture:** Strong leadership, transparent communication, and a positive work culture foster engagement, collaboration, and innovation.
5. **Stakeholder Value:** Success is measured not only by internal efficiency but also by the organization's impact on employees, customers, shareholders, and the broader community.